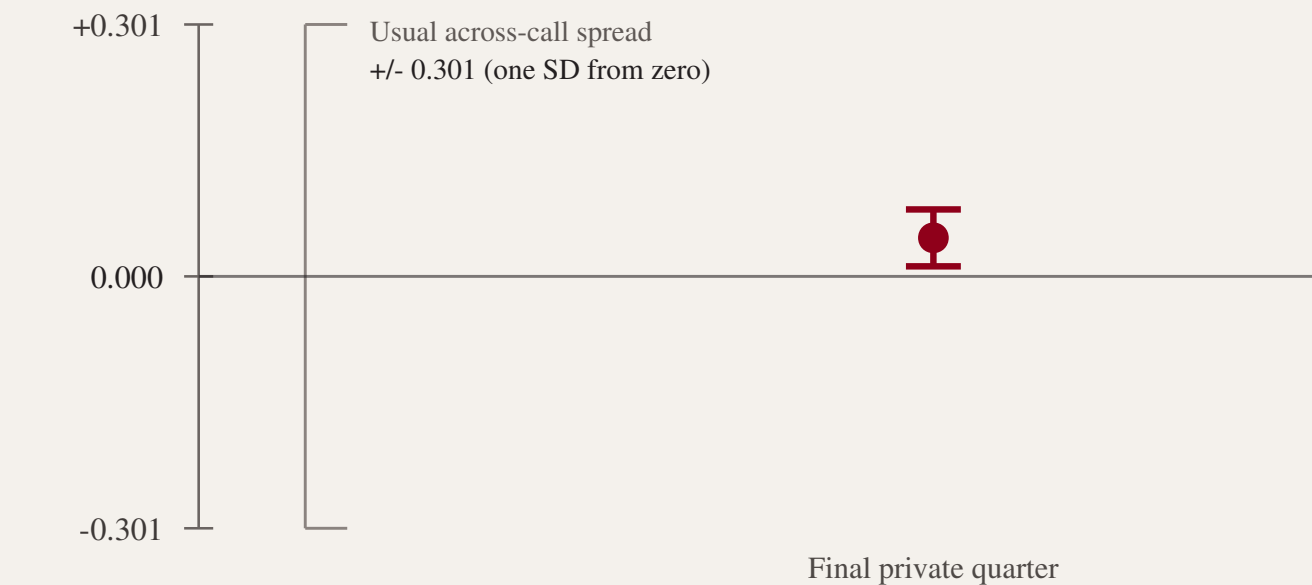


FINDING 1

Pre-announcement Run-up

Before a cash acquisition is announced, the same firm's CEO shows a **small but clear rise** in residual Q&A uncertainty.

Estimated change in residual CEO uncertainty



The model compares each firm's final private quarter with its ordinary quarters.

ESTIMATED WITHIN-FIRM SHIFT

+0.0461

Approx. 95% CI [0.012, 0.080]

SE 0.0172

Two-tailed p = 0.0074

About 15% of the usual spread

A modest but statistically clear increase.

$0.0461 / 0.3010 = 15.3\%$

SAMPLE	CONTROLS AND FIXED EFFECTS	INFERENCE	BOUNDARY
27,622 firm-quarters 1,248 firms	Leverage, size, Tobin's Q, ROA, capex, dividends, cash-flow volatility; firm and calendar year-quarter fixed effects	Standard errors clustered by firm	Descriptive, not causal